

LINE #	SPANISH	LITERAL ENGLISH	FAITHFUL ENGLISH	CULTURAL CONTEXT	TRANSLATION CLARIFICATION
1	Al pie del cerro del Tepeyac, cerca de la ciudad de México, hay una magnífica basílica dedicada a la Virgen de Guadalupe.	At the foot of the hill of Tepeyac, near Mexico City, there is a magnificent basilica dedicated to the Virgin of Guadalupe.	At the foot of Tepeyac Hill near Mexico City stands a magnificent basilica dedicated to Our Lady of Guadalupe.	Introduces sacred location tied to national and religious identity.	Basilica and 'Our Lady' translated for faithful, culturally accurate rendering.
2	Las cuantiosas y ricas dádivas de los fieles, han contribuido para que esta iglesia sea una de las más suntuosas de la República.	The abundant and rich gifts of the faithful have contributed so that this church is one of the most sumptuous in the Republic.	The rich offerings of the faithful have made this church one of the Republic's most splendid.	Highlights devotion and generosity of believers.	'Sumptuous' translated as 'splendid' to better fit natural English.

Sobre ese cerro existía en tiempos muy remotos, el templo de Tonantzin, consagrado á la diosa de los frutos 3 de la tierra.	Upon that hill, in very ancient times, there existed the temple of Tonantzin, consecrated to the goddess of the fruits of the earth.	Long ago, there stood on that hill the temple of Tonantzin, goddess of the earth's fruits.	Links Christian and pre-Hispanic sacred sites, syncretic layering.	Tonantzin kept untranslated as indigenous proper noun.
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Esta diosa era la Ceres, de los aztecas; pero al contrario de las demás divinidades indias, que sólo podían ser propiciadas con sacrificios 4 humanos...	This goddess was the Ceres of the Aztecs; but unlike other Indian divinities, who could only be appeased with human sacrifices...	This goddess, the Aztec Ceres, unlike other native deities, did not demand human sacrifices...	Comparison with Roman mythology reflects syncretic reinterpretation.	'Ceres' left untranslated as cultural reference.
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5	Tonantzin era una divinidad indulgente y tierna, a quien sólo agradaban las dádivas de flores o frutos...	Tonantzin was an indulgent and tender divinity, who only liked offerings of flowers or fruits...	Tonantzin, a gentle and tender goddess, accepted only offerings of flowers and fruits.	Highlights contrast with violent rites of other deities.	'Liked' translated as 'accepted' to better match reverence.
6	Tonantzin era la diosa protectora de los indios...	Tonantzin was the protective goddess of the Indians...	Tonantzin was the guardian goddess of the native peoples...	Emphasizes her protective maternal role.	as 'guardian' to reflect caring oversight.
7	En el pueblo de Cuautitlán vivía un indio llamado Juan Diego...	In the town of Cuautitlán lived an Indian named Juan Diego...	In Cuautitlán there lived a native man named Juan Diego...	Introduces humble protagonist.	'Indian' rendered as 'native man' to avoid outdated phrasing.
8	Un día, en el año de 1531, diez años y cuarto meses después de la conquista de México...	One day, in the year 1531, ten years and four months after the conquest of Mexico...	One day in 1531, ten years and four months after Mexico's conquest...	Establishes historical context for divine encounter.	Minor adjustment for natural phrasing in faithful translation.

9	...cuando repentinamente se le apareció la Virgen, deslumbrante de belleza.	...when suddenly the Virgin appeared to him, dazzling in beauty.	Suddenly, the Virgin appeared to him, radiant with beauty.	Divine vision emphasizing miraculous radiance.	"Dazzling" rendered as "radiant" for smoother faithful English.
10	Juan Diego se quedó extático, sin poder comprender lo que sus ojos contemplaban.	Juan Diego remained ecstatic, unable to comprehend what his eyes beheld.	Juan Diego stood in awe, unable to grasp what he saw.	Reflects wonder and incomprehension.	"Ecstatic" softened to "stood in awe" for natural flow.
11	La Virgen se dirigió á él, y con una voz armoniosa y dulce...	The Virgin addressed him, and with a harmonious and sweet voice...	The Virgin spoke to him in a harmonious and gentle voice...	Divine tenderness and maternal tone.	"Sweet" translated as "gentle" to reflect nuance.
12	...le dijo que fuera, en su nombre, a visitar al Ilustrísimo Obispo Sr. Fr. Juan de Zumárraga...	...told him to go, in her name, to visit the Illustrious Bishop Sr. Fr. Juan de Zumárraga...	...told him to visit the Most Reverend Bishop Juan de Zumárraga in her name...	Calls attention to church authority and divine will.	"Ilustrísimo" rendered as "Most Reverend" for ecclesiastical title.

13	...y que le dijera que ella deseaba que se le erigiera un templo en aquel lugar...	...and that he should tell him that she wished a temple to be erected in that place...	...and tell him she wished a temple to be built there...	Expression of divine desire and sacred space.	"Erected" simplified to "built" for natural phrasing.
14	Juan Diego trató de ver á Su Ilustrísima...	Juan Diego tried to see His Most Reverend...	Juan Diego tried to see the Bishop...	Reflects humble persistence.	Title simplified in faithful version for readability.
15	...no pudo conseguir que dicho señor le concediera una audiencia.	...could not get that lord to grant him an audience.	...but he was unable to obtain an audience.	Rejection reinforces his humility and trial.	"Señor" rendered as "him" for natural phrasing.
16	Así se lo manifestó a la Virgen...	Thus he manifested this to the Virgin...	So he explained this to the Virgin...	Demonstrates obedience and trust.	rendered as "explained" for clarity.
17	...quien al día siguiente se le volvió á aparecer en el mismo lugar...	...who the next day again appeared to him in the same place...	...who appeared again the next day in the same place...	Repetition of the divine presence.	Slight rearrangement for natural English syntax.
18	El indio trató por segunda vez de ver á su Señoría...	The Indian tried a second time to see His Lordship...	He tried again to see the Bishop...	Continued perseverance.	Simplified honorific in faithful version.

19	De vuelta a su casa, el indio tomó otra vereda para evitar encontrarse con la Virgen...	On returning home, the Indian took another path to avoid meeting the Virgin...	On his way home, Juan Diego tried to avoid the Virgin...	Demonstrates hesitation and human doubt.	"The Indian" rendered as "Juan Diego" for narrative clarity.
20	...pero ésta se le apareció de nuevo...	...but she appeared to him again...	...but she appeared to him again...	Reaffirms divine insistence.	Direct translation.
21	...y le ordenó que volviera y hablara con Su Ilustrísima...	...and ordered him to return and speak with His Most Reverend...	...and instructed him to go back and speak to the Bishop...	Emphasizes divine command.	"Ordered" softened to "instructed".
22	...y que le dijera que era la Virgen María, la Madre de Jesús, quien lo mandaba.	...and that he tell him that it was the Virgin Mary, the Mother of Jesus, who sent him.	...and to tell him that it was Mary, Mother of Jesus, who sent him.	Identifies divine authority explicitly.	Shortened slightly for smooth reading.
23	Juan Diego obedeció la divina orden...	Juan Diego obeyed the divine order...	Juan Diego obeyed the divine command...	Shows humility and obedience.	"Order" rendered as "command" for religious context.
24	...pero el Obispo no dió crédito al mensaje del indio.	...but the Bishop did not give credit to the Indian's message.	...but the Bishop did not believe Juan Diego's message.	Skepticism and test of faith.	"Did not believe" more natural than "did not give credit".

25	...le indicó que pidiera a la Virgen alguna prenda que acreditara la autenticidad de las apariciones.	...indicated to him to ask the Virgin for some token to prove the authenticity of the apparitions.	...asked him to request a sign from the Virgin to prove the apparitions.	Typical narrative motif of proof demanded.	"Token" rendered as "sign" for clarity.
26	El doce de diciembre la Virgen se le apareció por la cuarta vez.	On December twelfth, the Virgin appeared to him for the fourth time.	On December 12th, the Virgin appeared to him for the fourth time.	Key event: marks Feast Day in Catholic calendar.	Date rendered in standard numeric English form.
27	Juan Diego le comunicó desconsolado el deseo del Obispo.	Juan Diego, disconsolate, told her the Bishop's wish.	Saddened, Juan Diego told her the Bishop's demand.	Demonstrates his emotional struggle.	"Disconsolado" rendered as "saddened".
28	...a la cumbre del cerro, que cortara rosas de las que allí encontrara...	...to the top of the hill, to cut roses from those he would find there...	...to the hilltop to gather roses that he would find there...	The miraculous sign involves unseasonal roses.	"Cut" rendered as "gather" for gentler tone.
29	...y que se las llevara al Obispo...	...and to take them to the Bishop...	...and to bring them to the Bishop...	message to convince the church.	"Take" simplified to "bring" for natural English.

30	...Juan Diego la miró sorprendido.	...Juan Diego looked at her surprised.	Juan Diego looked at her in amazement.	Expresses wonder and disbelief.	"Surprised" rendered as "amazement".
31	Rosas en el cerro del Tepeyac! En un lugar tan seco y árido...	Roses on Tepeyac Hill! In such a dry and arid place...	Roses on Tepeyac Hill—in such a dry and barren place!	The miracle contrasts nature and divinity.	"Arid" softened to "barren" for fluency.
32	...y además en pleno invierno!	...and besides, in the middle of winter!	...and during winter, no less!	Emphasizes the impossibility.	rendering to match emphasis.
33	...el indio por fin se resolvió a subir...	...the Indian finally resolved to climb...	Juan Diego finally decided to go up...	Human hesitation and decision.	"The Indian" replaced with "Juan Diego".
34	...Grande fue su admiración...	...Great was his admiration...	He was greatly amazed...	Reinforces wonder.	Slight rephrasing for flow.
35	...hermosísimas rosas, y tan fragantes que el ambiente estaba todo perfumado.	...very beautiful roses, so fragrant that the air was all perfumed.	...beautiful and fragrant roses filled the air with perfume.	Symbolic of divine grace.	Simplified for natural phrasing.
36	El indio cortó las rosas, las depositó en su tilma de ayate...	The Indian cut the roses, placed them in his tilma of ayate...	Juan Diego gathered the roses and placed them in his ayate cloak...	Ayate is traditional indigenous fabric.	Cultural term "ayate" retained.

37	...y se fue alegremente al Palacio Episcopal...	...and went happily to the Episcopal Palace...	...and joyfully went to the Bishop's Palace...	Joy and divine mission.	"Happily" rendered as "joyfully".
38	...en donde su Ilustrísima se dignó recibirlo.	...where His Most Reverend deigned to receive him.	...where the Bishop finally agreed to see him.	Clerical authority and humility.	Simplified ecclesiastical phrase.
39	Indescriptible fue la admiración del Prelado...	Indescribable was the admiration of the Prelate...	The Bishop was speechless with wonder...	Signals miracle's impact on religious authority.	"Prelate" changed to "Bishop".
40	...una lluvia de rosas cayó sobre el pavimento...	...a rain of roses fell onto the pavement...	...roses spilled onto the floor...	Miracle evokes divine grace.	"Rain of roses" rendered more natural as "spilled".
41	...y la milagrosa imagen de la Virgen apareció sobre la tilma.	...and the miraculous image of the Virgin appeared on the tilma.	...and the Virgin's miraculous image appeared on the cloak.	Iconic moment: origin of the sacred image.	"Tilma" rendered as "cloak" for readability.
42	Pasada la primera impresión...	After the first impression passed...	Once the initial shock passed...	The Bishop's reaction shifts from awe to action.	"Impression" rephrased to "shock".
43	...dispuso que se condujese la imagen, en solemne procesión...	...he ordered that the image be taken, in solemn procession...	...he arranged for the image to be carried in solemn procession...	Processions are important in Catholic rites.	"Ordered" softened to "arranged".

44	...y poco después se erigió el magnífico santuario...	...and soon after the magnificent sanctuary was erected...	...and soon the magnificent sanctuary was built...	Key event: creation of pilgrimage site.	"Erected" simplified to "built".
45	...en que se venera la Virgen de Guadalupe...	...where the Virgin of Guadalupe is venerated...	...where the Virgin of Guadalupe is worshipped...	Site becomes central to Mexican faith.	"Venerated" rendered as "worshipped".
46	...patrona especial de la Nación Mexicana.	...special patroness of the Mexican Nation.	...the special patroness of Mexico.	Establishes her national significance.	"Nation" simplified to "Mexico".
47	De todas partes del país concurría gente...	From all parts of the country people gathered...	People came from all over the country...	Shows the rapid spread of devotion.	Simplified for natural flow.
48	...y en la devoción para ella se mezcló desde entonces una gran dosis de patriotismo.	...and in the devotion to her was mixed from then on a great dose of patriotism.	...and devotion to her became intertwined with patriotism.	Merges sacred and national identity.	"Mixed" rendered as "intertwined".
49	La Virgen está representada en esa pintura...	The Virgin is represented in that painting...	The Virgin appears in that painting...	Description of sacred iconography.	Simplified to "appears".

50	...cubierta con una túnica rosa bordada de oro...	...covered with a pink tunic embroidered with gold...	...wearing a pink tunic embroidered in gold...	Describes her majestic appearance.	"Covered" made more natural as "wearing".
51	...y un manto azul salpicado de estrellas...	...and a blue mantle sprinkled with stars...	...and a blue mantle dotted with stars...	Stars link to celestial symbolism.	"Sprinkled" changed to "dotted" for clarity.
52	...la cabeza ceñida de...	...her head bound with...	...her head encircled by...	Completes sacred image of the Virgin.	"Bound" softened to "encircled".